

Macro Report Pipeline Update: What I Changed, What I Found, What Got Stuck

Divyanshu sent an 11-point review of the nightly briefing PDF (`Report update todo details.md`). I used that as the spec for a full pass on the engine and report pipeline. Below I match my implementation plan against the current status file, answer the questions he raised, and flag what still needs a decision from him.

The short version

Area	My plan (<code>MACRO_REPORT_UPDATE_PLAN.md</code>)	Where things stand (2026-06-09)
Phase 1: CONFIG + metadata	Done	Done
Phase 2: Engine logic (R-01 to R-11)	Done	10/11 done; R-10 partial
Phase 3: Briefing/PDF pipeline	Done	Done (I also fixed PDF table overlap)
Phase 4: Tests	15+ passing	15 combo tests + 5 briefing tests
Phase 5: Docs	Done	Requirements, plan, analysis, status files
MRU follow-ups	MRU-01..03	Done; MRU-04..06 still open

My nightly PDFs now show per-combo horizons, bearish E at 12M, CANCELLED Combo C, EASY MONEY posture, and a CFTC source note. I have **not** been able to validate the G→B early-warning story in automated backtest yet.

Divyanshu's 11 points vs what I shipped

#	His ask	Req	Plan phase	Status	What I changed
1	Combo E hit rate inverted (~19.9%)	R-01	2a, 3	Done	Bearish + 12M in <code>combo_hit_rates</code> ; <code>raw_hit_rate</code> counts SPX down
2	Combo C should be CANCELLED, not INACTIVE	R-02	2b, 3	Done	<code>cancel_date</code> column; brown row; smoke test PASS (MRU-03)
3	Combo F week 10: show episode start	R-03	2f, 3	Done	Week N of 26 (MEDIUM) · started YYYY-MM-DD
4	No commanding/ dismal; use 3m not three	R-04	3b	Done	Claude prompt + Python <code>dominant_reason</code> templates
5	E confirmed but CFTC 5th pctile: which legs?	R-05	2e, 3	Done	<code>confirmed_legs</code> : [CAPE, NFCI] on CONFIRMED rows
6	WALCL 0.03% MoM at 85th pctile wrong	R-06	Phase 1	Done	WALCL <code>pctile_window</code> : full from 2008; flat MoM ~51st now
7	BRAVE → EASY MONEY	R-07	2d, 3	Done	<code>EASY_MONEY</code> in detector; <code>TACTICAL EASY MONEY</code> in briefing
8	Clarify CFTC source	R-08	3a	Done	TFF · S&P 500 Consolidated · Lev Money net
9	Per-combo horizons, not uniform 3M	R-09	2a, 3	Done	See table below; G = N/A
10	G→B test; HY audit; G from 2007 only	R-10	2c + MRU	Partial	I ran scripts; 0 G fires; <code>keep_400bps</code> ; appendix not in PDF yet
11	C HOT fire; governing CPI cancel; no PPI	R-11	2b	Done	Fire: $CPI \geq +0.2pp$ hot; cancel: latest $CPI \leq$ consensus

Horizons I configured (his point 9)

Combo	Primary	Secondary	Hit rate?	Direction
A	6M	3M	Yes	Bullish
B	3M	n/a	Yes	Bullish
C	6M	3M	Yes	Bearish
D	5D	n/a	Yes	Bearish
E	12M	n/a	Yes	Bearish
F	6M	3M	Yes	Bullish
G	n/a	n/a	N/A	Timing warning only

That lines up with what he asked for: E at 12M, D at ~5 days, G with no return hit rate. Worth noting here is that I seperated primary and secondary horizons in CONFIG so the PDF row labels update automatically.

My plan phases: planned vs delivered

Rollout order in the plan was Config → Engine → Nightly → Briefing → Tests → Docs.

Phase	I planned	I delivered	Evidence
1	combo_metadata.py , horizons, WALCL full pctile	Yes	CONFIG.yaml , new module
2	C fire/cancel, B HY dual, A vote, E legs, F start	Yes	combo_detector.py , combo_c_cancel.py , etc.
3	Briefing table, Claude prompt, CANCELLED, CFTC	Yes	briefing_renderer.py , nightly_briefing.py
4	Six test files	Yes	15 passed first pass; +PDF test after layout fix
5	Analysis + master doc	Yes	MACRO_REPORT_UPDATE_*.md
Post-plan	MRU-01..03	Yes	analyze_combo_g_b_cascade.py , smoke on 2026-07-03

Answers to his explicit questions (point 10 and related)

How many post-2007 B fires had G within 6 weeks?

He suggested that if all 5 had G within 6 weeks, G would be a perfect early warning.

Metric	His reference instances	My backtest (2007–2026)
G→B within 6 weeks	~3–4 week leads cited	0/3 B episodes (0%)
G fires in full scan	Aug 2015, Dec 2018, COVID, Apr 2025	0 G fires in 1,018 Fridays
B ACTIVE episodes	8 confirmed since 1990 (manual)	3 in my automated rescan

My answer: I cannot confirm G as early warning from the detector + DB today. I need to build the manual episode table (MRU-06) for his canonical dates.

HY at every B fire: 400bps floor + dual 80th pctile?

Check	My result
Any fire in 375–400 bps?	No
Keep 400bps floor?	Yes
Dual gate implemented?	Yes (400bps + 80th pctile full history)

Label	Date	HY bps	Pctile	Dual OK?
Pre-Aug 2015	2015-08-21	618.0	82.5	Yes
Pre-Dec 2018	2018-12-21	455.9	42.1	No
Pre-COVID	2020-03-20	850.0	97.2	Yes
Oct 2022	2022-10-07	427.1	35.4	No

My answer: 400bps is fine. The dual gate blocks Oct 2022 and Dec 2018. I need his sign-off on that tension (MRU-04).

G testable from 2007 only?

Yes. I added that to the Claude prompt. VXTS data starts 2007.

Is the narrative tone Claude or Python?

Both. I control `dominant_reason` in Python (neutral, numeric horizons). Claude writes the body under SYSTEM guardrails I added in point 4.

How is WALCL percentile computed?

MoM% on weekly resampled WALCL, not the absolute level. The bug was `rolling_3y` during QT making +0.03% look like the 85th pctl. I switched to `full` from 2008-01-01.

Files I touched

Layer	Files
Config	<code>macro_intelligence/CONFIG.yaml</code>
Engine	<code>combo_metadata.py</code> , <code>combo_detector.py</code> , <code>combo_c_cancel.py</code> , <code>dominant.py</code>
Nightly	<code>nightly_run.py</code>
Output	<code>briefing_renderer.py</code> , <code>json_writer.py</code> , <code>nightly_briefing.py</code>
Schema	<code>schema.sql</code> , <code>migrate.py</code>
Tests	<code>test_combo_*.py</code> , <code>test_walcl_percentile.py</code> , <code>test_briefing_renderer.py</code>
Analysis	<code>scripts/analyze_combo_g_b_cascade.py</code>
Outputs	<code>runic_briefing_2026-06-09.pdf</code> , <code>runic_briefing_2026-07-03.pdf</code>

What gave me trouble

Issue	What happened	What I did
HY % vs bps	FRED HY in %; spec in bps	<code>_hy_oas_bps()</code> helper
WALCL false 85th	Rolling 3Y in QT regime	Full history from 2008
Combo C cancel in May	CPI governing prints HOT	Found 4 clean Fridays Jun 12–Jul 3 for smoke test
Zero G fires	No Friday met all 3 G legs	Logged it; MRU-05/06 for manual dates

Issue	What happened	What I did
Oct 2022 vs dual HY	427 bps passes abs, fails 35th pctlile	Flagged for Divyanshu (MRU-04)
DB vs rescan	89 B WATCH, 0 ACTIVE in <code>combo_fires</code>	Used rescan for MRU; no reconcile yet
FRED 504	Live nightly pull timed out	Fell back to DB cache some runs
PDF table overlap	Duration bled into Direction column	Paragraph wrap in ReportLab
FRED HY for audit	API only ~3 years	Used <code>daily_readings</code> back to 1997
Combo E duration blank	CONFIRMED has no week counter	Shows <code>legs</code> <code>CAPE</code> , <code>NFCI</code> only (by design)

On the flip side, the experiment rescan only took ~13 minutes once I pointed it at the DB instead of FRED. That part was manageable.

Still open (`MACRO_REPORT_UPDATE_STATUS.md`)

ID	Item	Blocker
MRU-04	HY dual 80th vs Oct 2022	Divyanshu sign-off
MRU-05	G detection (0 fires)	Data / detector audit
MRU-06	Manual G/B/SPX bottom table	His confirmed dates
Unticketed	G/B appendix in PDF	Not wired yet
Unticketed	CFTC full-history pctlile for B/E	CONFIG still 156-week

What I'd do next

1. Get Divyanshu's call on the HY dual gate before the next backfill (Oct 2022 is the stress-test date).
2. Build MRU-06 manual episode table and add it to the briefing appendix.
3. Reconcile `combo_fires` with the current detector so B WATCH vs ACTIVE counts make sense.

4. Show "legs met" on B WATCH (e.g. 1/3) so partial watch rows do not read like near-capitulation.

My doubts and questions

- Divyanshu cites 8 confirmed B instances since 1990; my rescan finds 3. Is that mostly WATCH vs ACTIVE definition, or did my pre-2023 backfill use old rules?
 - Zero G fires feels wrong given Aug 2015 and Dec 2018 anecdotes. Is VXTS or HY 4wk data too sparse early on, or are my thresholds too tight?
 - Combo E at 18.9% (12M bearish) is directionally right now, but n=507 mixes regimes and the data shows some pretty flat slices across fed cycles. Should I show regime-conditional hit rates in the PDF?
 - The dual HY rule makes sense on paper but contradicts Oct 2022 as a B date. Which wins: the rule or his canonical list?
 - I fixed the Claude tone guardrails in the prompt, but I have not done a careful read of every live narrative since. Did "commanding" and "dismal" actually disappear in production output?
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Sources: `Report update todo details.md`, `MACRO_REPORT_UPDATE_STATUS.md`,
`MACRO_REPORT_UPDATE_PLAN.md`, `MACRO_REPORT_UPDATE_ANALYSIS.md` Parts 1–2,
`mru01_mru02_results.json`.